

Andrew Stoltzfus

User Experience Research Lead

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Accomplished UX researcher with more than a decade of experience improving highly technical products for companies like F5 Networks, Microsoft, and Google. Proudest accomplishment is establishing the practice of UX research at a billion-dollar company.

Unique background as a former IT practitioner and human-computer interaction psychologist who now applies full-spectrum UX research methodologies and a problem-solving mindset to identify user needs and collaborate with stakeholders to define and test the best possible solution the business can deliver.

I enjoy simplifying complex tools into intuitive experiences for security, data analysis, and other enterprise users, and am interested to continue working with cutting-edge cloud, AI, and networking products.

Portfolio: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/andrew-stoltzfus-1744551/>
(under "Featured")

EXPERIENCE

F5 Networks — Senior UX Researcher

2011 - 2023

- First UX researcher for F5; established and evangelized the practice of UX research for a billion-dollar company.
- Led the UX research (UXR) process for multiple generations of F5's central management software for its entire product suite with \$1+ billion in annual sales, from requirement gathering to design exploration to iterative usability testing and ongoing improvements.
- Established an in-product mechanism in the central management suite to let users provide feedback and satisfaction measures, and a back-end dashboard to let stakeholders explore the data.
- Led UXR for an in-house skunkworks/startup for giving executives real-time visibility into their enterprise IT security status.
- Designed and validated the information architecture for multiple complex products.
- Established, evangelized, and maintained F5's user personas across engineering, PM, sales and marketing orgs. This greatly improved feature prioritization and testing.

Microsoft — User Experience Researcher

2008 - 2011

Windows Server

SKILLS

Information Architecture

Lab-based usability studies

Remote usability studies

Research automation

Rapid iterative testing

Survey design

Focus groups

User interviews / ethnography

Heuristic evaluation

Task analysis

Persona development

Competitive analysis

Benchmarking

Accessibility evaluation

User requirement gathering

Agile / SAFe

TOOLS & PLATFORMS

Figma

Maze

UserTesting.com

Optimal Workshop

SurveyMonkey

Qualtrics

Cloud & hybrid environments

AWS

Azure

- Extensive lab studies for usability **testing** and comprehensive **UX** benchmarking of the flagship Windows Server **product** during development.
- Led UXR for a new software modeling utility for IT professionals.
- Through heuristic review, discovered a catastrophic **interaction problem** with Windows Server Manager that would have otherwise shipped with millions of units.

Office

- Automated the extraction of data from internal **UX** database sources, greatly increasing **research** data access for other **UX** researchers.
- On short notice, designed and executed a competitive **product** study with 100 participants and 20 separate applications from 4 companies.

Windows Media Center

- In-home ethnography/**user** interviews to define the next generation of Microsoft entertainment software and hardware.
- Out-of-box studies to improve the hardware and software setup **experience** for entertainment systems.

Google — **Quality** Assessor (contract)

2006 - 2008

- Evaluated usability and **quality** of search results for web, image, and map search, on both PC and mobile devices. Moderated focus group discussions. Bundled results and presented to senior **UX** team.

Seattle Housing Authority — *Network Administrator*

2000 - 2004

- Rollout and operations of Windows and Unix systems and applications. Infrastructure project **management**, enterprise-wide support. Network troubleshooting and repair.

EDUCATION

Master of **Science** (M.S.) in **Human-Computer Interaction**

University of Surrey, United Kingdom

Behavioral & information **science** program; graduated with honors

Bachelor of Arts (B.A.) in Psychology

University of Texas at Dallas

Minor in neurobiology

Andrew Stoltzfus

- Newcastle, WA, US

Contact Information

- 4yw-dc0-jku@mail.dice.com

Work History

Total Work **Experience**: 18 years

- Senior **UX Researcher** F5 Inc
Dec 01, 2011
- Usability **Researcher** Microsoft
Apr 01, 2008
- **Quality** Assessor Google (Contract)
Apr 01, 2006

Education

- **Bachelors** | Univerity of Texas as Dallas
- **Masters** | Univeristy of Surrey

Skills

- **human-computer interaction** - 15 years
- heuristic **analysis** - 12 years
- interviewing - 10 years
- survey **design** - 10 years
- agile - 8 years
- benchmarking - 8 years

- **cloud computing** - 8 years
- **competitor analysis** - 8 years
- **figma** - 5 years
- **focus groups** - 5 years
- **usability testing** - 15 years
- **research** - 13 years
- **ux** - 13 years
- **information architecture** - 12 years
- **it security** - 12 years
- **personas** - 12 years

Work Preferences

- Desired Work Settings: No Preference
- Likely to Switch: True
- Willing to Relocate: False
- Travel Preference: 0%
- Work Authorization:
 - US
- Work Documents:
 - US CitizenSecurity Clearance: False
- Third Party: False
- Employment Type:
 - Full-time
 - Contract - W2

Profile Sources

- linkedin: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/andrew-stoltzfus-1744551>
- Dice:
<https://www.dice.com/employer/talent/profile/97298248ee79298675a96f9c2dce7985>